

gemstone-rs BridgeRoot and Object Mapping

A first MagLev-style bridge-root mapping layer over OOPs



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BridgeRoot and Object Mapping

`gemstone-rs` now has a first object-mapping layer over the lower-level `Oop` API.

This is intentionally smaller than MagLev/GBS object mapping. It gives Rust code a bridge-root dictionary, typed Rust payload mapping, nested read-back, and generated mapping support while keeping direct OOP access available.

What Is Supported

The initial mapping layer supports:

- `Session::bridge_root()`
- `Session::bridge_root_named(name)`
- `BridgeRoot::put`
- `BridgeRoot::put_mapped`
- `BridgeRoot::put_mapped_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::put_field`
- `BridgeRoot::put_field_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::put_string`
- `BridgeRoot::put_string_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::put_symbol`
- `BridgeRoot::put_symbol_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::put_smallint`
- `BridgeRoot::put_smallint_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::put_bool`
- `BridgeRoot::put_bool_with_key_type`
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- `BridgeRoot::put_map`
- `BridgeRoot::put_map_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::put_optional`
- `BridgeRoot::put_optional_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_oop`
- `BridgeRoot::get_value`
- `BridgeRoot::get_bridge_value`
- `BridgeRoot::get_bridge_value_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_bridge_value_with_depth`
- `BridgeRoot::get_field`
- `BridgeRoot::get_field_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_vec`
- `BridgeRoot::get_vec_with_key_type`

- `BridgeRoot::get_map`
- `BridgeRoot::get_map_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_optional`
- `BridgeRoot::get_optional_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_string`
- `BridgeRoot::get_string_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_smallint`
- `BridgeRoot::get_smallint_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_bool`
- `BridgeRoot::get_bool_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_dictionary`
- `BridgeRoot::get_dictionary_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::get_mapped`
- `BridgeRoot::get_mapped_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::remove`
- `BridgeRoot::remove_with_key_type`
- `BridgeRoot::commit`
- `BridgeRoot::commit_with_retry`
- `BridgeRoot::transaction`
- `BridgeRoot::keys`
- `BridgeRoot::contains_key`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_oop`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_value`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_bridge_value`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_bridge_value_with_key_type`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_bridge_value_with_depth`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_string`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_smallint`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_bool`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_dictionary`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_field`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_mapped`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_vec`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_map`
- `BridgeDictionary::at_optional`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_field`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_string`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_symbol`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_smallint`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_bool`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_vec`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_map`
- `BridgeDictionary::put_optional`
- `BridgeDictionary::contains_key`
- `BridgeDictionary::keys`

- BridgeKey
- BridgeKeyType::String
- BridgeKeyType::Symbol
- BridgeMapped
- #[derive(BridgeMapped)]
- BridgeFieldRead
- BridgeFieldWrite
- BridgeValue::Nil
- BridgeValue::Bool
- BridgeValue::SmallInt
- BridgeValue::String
- BridgeValue::Symbol
- BridgeValue::Oop
- BridgeValue::Dictionary
- BridgeValue::KeyedDictionary
- BridgeValue::Array
- BridgeValue::from_oop
- BridgeValue::from_oop_with_depth
- session-local OOP identity ids with Session::identity_for_oop

The default root is a GemStone Dictionary stored in UserGlobals under #GemStoneRsBridgeRoot.

Rust Example

```
use gemstone_rs::{BridgeValue, Config, Session};

fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {
    let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;

    let payload = BridgeValue::dictionary([
        ("name".to_string(), BridgeValue::from("Tariq")),
        ("amount".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(100_i64)),
        ("currency".to_string(), BridgeValue::from("GBP")),
    ]);

    let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;
    let payload_oop = bridge_root.put("MyTestDict", payload)?;
    let stored = bridge_root.get_oop("MyTestDict"?);
    assert_eq!(payload_oop, stored);

    bridge_root.commit()?;
    Ok(())
}
```

Run the example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example bridge_root_mapping
```

Expected output includes:

```
bridge root: GemStoneRsBridgeRoot
MyTestDict OOP: <number>
```

Typed Rust Struct Mapping

For application code, implement `BridgeMapped` on a plain Rust type. The trait keeps the mapping explicit and reviewable while removing repeated dictionary field reads from application code.

```
use gemstone_rs::{
    BridgeDictionary, BridgeFieldWrite, BridgeKeyType, BridgeMapped, BridgeValue,
    Config, Session,
};
use std::collections::BTreeMap;

#[derive(Debug, Eq, PartialEq)]
struct BookingDraft {
    name: String,
    amount: i64,
    currency: String,
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,
}

impl BridgeMapped for BookingDraft {
    fn to_bridge_value(&self) -> BridgeValue {
        BridgeValue::dictionary([
            ("name".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(self.name.clone())),
            ("amount".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(self.amount)),
            ("currency".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(self.currency.clone())),
            ("labels".to_string(),
                BridgeFieldWrite::to_bridge_field_value(&self.labels)),
        ])
    }

    fn from_bridge_dictionary(dictionary: &mut BridgeDictionary<'_>) ->
        gemstone_rs::Result<Self> {
        Ok(Self {
            name: dictionary.at_string("name")?,
            amount: dictionary.at_smallint("amount")?,
            currency: dictionary.at_string("currency")?,
            labels: dictionary.at_map("labels")?,
        })
    }
}

fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {
```

```

let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;
let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;

let draft = BookingDraft {
    name: "Tariq".to_string(),
    amount: 100,
    currency: "GBP".to_string(),
    labels: BTreeMap::from([("source".to_string(), "manual".to_string())]),
};

bridge_root.put_mapped("MyTestDict", &draft)?;
let loaded: BookingDraft = bridge_root.get_mapped("MyTestDict")?;
assert_eq!(loaded, draft);

bridge_root.put_string("MyTestStatus", "ready")?;
bridge_root.put_smallint("MyTestAmount", draft.amount)?;
bridge_root.put_bool("MyTestApproved", true)?;
bridge_root.put_vec("MyTestTags", &["priority".to_string(),
"demo".to_string()])?;
bridge_root.put_optional("MyTestNote", &Some("front desk".to_string()))?;
bridge_root.put_map("MyTestLabels", &draft.labels)?;

assert_eq!(bridge_root.get_string("MyTestStatus")?, "ready");
assert_eq!(bridge_root.get_smallint("MyTestAmount")?, draft.amount);
assert!(bridge_root.get_bool("MyTestApproved")?);
let tags: Vec<String> = bridge_root.get_vec("MyTestTags")?;
assert_eq!(tags, vec!["priority".to_string(), "demo".to_string()]);
let note: Option<String> = bridge_root.get_optional("MyTestNote")?;
assert_eq!(note, Some("front desk".to_string()));
let labels: BTreeMap<String, String> = bridge_root.get_map("MyTestLabels")?;
assert_eq!(labels, draft.labels);

bridge_root.put_map_with_key_type(
    "MyTestLabelsSymbol",
    BridgeKeyType::Symbol,
    &draft.labels,
)?;
let symbol_labels: BTreeMap<String, String> =
    bridge_root.get_map_with_key_type("MyTestLabelsSymbol",
BridgeKeyType::Symbol)?;
assert_eq!(symbol_labels, draft.labels);

bridge_root.commit()?;
Ok(())
}

```

The checked-in example uses this pattern:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example bridge_root_mapping
```

Expected output includes:

```

bridge root: GemStoneRsBridgeRoot
MyTestDict OOP: <number>
loaded payload: BookingDraft { name: "Tariq", amount: 100, currency: "GBP", labels:
{"source": "manual"} }
loaded status: ready
loaded amount: 100
loaded approved: true
loaded tags: ["priority", "demo"]
loaded note: Some("front desk")
loaded labels: {"source": "manual"}
loaded symbol labels: {"source": "manual"}

```

Dynamic BridgeValue Inspection

When you do not want a typed struct yet, read a BridgeRoot value back as a dynamic `BridgeValue` tree:

```

use gemstone_rs::{BridgeValue, Config, Session};

fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {
    let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;
    let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;

    let payload = BridgeValue::dictionary([
        (
            "customer".to_string(),
            BridgeValue::dictionary([
                ("name".to_string(), BridgeValue::from("Tariq")),
                ("vip".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(true)),
            ]),
        ),
        (
            "items".to_string(),
            BridgeValue::array([
                BridgeValue::dictionary([
                    ("sku".to_string(), BridgeValue::from("A-1")),
                    ("quantity".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(2_i64)),
                ]),
            ]),
        ),
        ("state".to_string(), BridgeValue::Symbol("ready".to_string())),
        ("note".to_string(), BridgeValue::Nil),
    ]);

    bridge_root.put("BridgeValueInspection", payload.clone())?;
    let dynamic = bridge_root.get_bridge_value("BridgeValueInspection")?;
    assert_eq!(dynamic, payload);
    Ok(())
}

```


Run the checked-in live example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example bridge_value_inspection
```

Expected output includes:

```
dynamic BridgeValue: Dictionary({"customer": Dictionary(...), "items": Array(...),  
"note": Nil, "state": Symbol("ready")})  
bridge root identity: <number>  
bridge root key count: <number>
```

`BridgeValue::from_oop_with_depth(session, oop, max_depth)` is also available for inspectors and tools. It reads nil, booleans, small integers, characters, strings, symbols, arrays, and string/symbol-keyed dictionaries. When the reader hits an unsupported object, a repeated object, or the depth limit, it returns `BridgeValue::Oop(oop)` instead of pretending the object is transparent Rust state.

Derive-Based Mapping

For normal Rust structs, prefer `#[derive(BridgeMapped)]`. The derive writes a `BridgeMapped` implementation that stores fields in a GemStone dictionary and reads them back into Rust.

```
use gemstone_rs::{BridgeMapped, Config, Session};  
use std::collections::BTreeMap;  
  
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]  
struct CustomerDraft {  
    #[bridge(key_type = "Symbol")]  
    name: String,  
}  
  
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]  
struct BookingDraft {  
    #[bridge(key = "amount", key_type = "Symbol")]  
    amount: i64,  
    customer: CustomerDraft,  
    tags: Vec<String>,  
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,  
    note: Option<String>,  
}  
  
fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {  
    let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;  
    let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;  
  
    let draft = BookingDraft {  
        amount: 100,  
        customer: CustomerDraft {
```

```

        name: "Tariq".to_string(),
    },
    tags: vec!["priority".to_string(), "demo".to_string()],
    labels: BTreeMap::from([("source".to_string(), "derive".to_string())]),
    note: None,
};

bridge_root.put_mapped("DerivedBookingDraft", &draft)?;
let loaded: BookingDraft = bridge_root.get_mapped("DerivedBookingDraft"?;
assert_eq!(loaded, draft);

bridge_root.commit()?;
Ok(())
}

```

Run the checked-in live example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example derive_mapping
```

Expected output includes:

```

derived mapped payload: BookingDraft { amount: 100, customer: CustomerDraft { name:
"Tariq" }, tags: ["priority", "demo"], labels: {"source": "derive"}, note: None }
bridge root identity: <number>

```

Nested Read-Back

Nested mapped structs and arrays round-trip through the same bridge dictionary format:

Rust field	GemStone storage	Read-back helper
String	String	BridgeFieldRead / at_string
i64	SmallInteger	BridgeFieldRead / at_smallint
bool	true / false	BridgeFieldRead / at_bool
Oop	raw object reference	BridgeFieldRead / at_oop
another BridgeMapped struct	nested Dictionary	BridgeDictionary::at_mapped
Vec<T>	Array	BridgeDictionary::at_vec
BTreeMap<String, T>	string-keyed Dictionary	BridgeDictionary::at_map
Option<T>	value, nil, or missing key	BridgeFieldRead

This lets a Rust payload keep normal nested shape:

```
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct BookingDraft {
    customer: CustomerDraft,
    tags: Vec<String>,
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,
    note: Option<String>,
}
```

Optional fields are useful when a BridgeRoot dictionary evolves over time. `None` writes as `GemStone nil`; read-back returns `None` when the key is missing or when the stored value is `nil`. `Some(value)` reads through the inner field type, so `Option<CustomerDraft>` still reports nested mapping errors with the full field path.

When read-back fails, mapping errors include field context:

```
field amount expected GemStone value type SmallInt, got 0op 1234
field booking.customer.name expected GemStone value type String, got 00P 1234
field tags[2] expected GemStone value type String, got 00P 1234
field labels["source"] expected GemStone value type String, got 00P 1234
```

Nested mapped read-back preserves the full field path, and array read-back reports the failing element index. Both are important when generated mappings read back nested payloads from a live stone. Lookup failures are also wrapped with the current path, so missing keys and invalid nested arrays point at `booking.items` or `booking.items[2]` instead of only returning a generic `GemStone` lookup error.

Dynamic `BridgeValue` read-back uses the same path-aware machinery when called through `BridgeRoot::get_bridge_value` or `BridgeDictionary::at_bridge_value`. That makes it useful for explorer panels and generated-wrapper debugging before you settle on a typed `BridgeMapped` struct.

Key Policy

`GemStone` dictionaries often use either string keys or symbol keys. The mapping layer makes that explicit:

```
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct BookingDraft {
    #[bridge(key = "amount", key_type = "Symbol")]
    amount: i64,
}
```

Manual code can use the same policy:

```
use gemstone_rs::BridgeKeyType;

bridge_root.put_with_key_type("BookingDraft", BridgeKeyType::Symbol, "stored"?;
let oop = bridge_root.get_oop_with_key_type("BookingDraft", BridgeKeyType::Symbol)?;
```

The typed helpers have the same key-policy variants:

```
bridge_root.put_field_with_key_type("BookingLabels", BridgeKeyType::Symbol,
&draft.labels)?;
let labels: BTreeMap<String, String> =
    bridge_root.get_map_with_key_type("BookingLabels", BridgeKeyType::Symbol)?;
```

Use string keys when interoperating with JSON-like payloads and symbol keys when you want Smalltalk-style dictionary access.

Transactions and Identity

`BridgeRoot::transaction` commits on success and aborts on error:

```
bridge_root.transaction(|root| {
    root.put_mapped("BookingDraft", &draft)?;
    let loaded: BookingDraft = root.get_mapped("BookingDraft"?;
    assert_eq!(loaded, draft);
    Ok(())
})?;
```

For conflict-prone commits, use a bounded retry:

```
bridge_root.put_mapped("BookingDraft", &draft)?;
bridge_root.commit_with_retry(2)?;
```

`Session` also tracks a session-local identity id for OOPs it sees:

```
let oop = bridge_root.get_oop("BookingDraft"?;
let identity = bridge_root.identity_id();
println!("bridge root identity={identity}, payload oop={}", oop.raw());
```

That is not transparent object persistence. It is a stable in-session cache key for wrappers, inspectors, and explorer views.

Relationship-Shaped Payloads

Use nested structs and vectors when the Rust boundary needs a relationship-like shape but you still want explicit persistence. This keeps the GemStone side a plain dictionary graph and keeps the Rust side strongly typed:

```
use gemstone_rs::BridgeMapped;
use std::collections::BTreeMap;

#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct CustomerDraft {
    name: String,
    email: String,
}

#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct LineItemDraft {
    sku: String,
    quantity: i64,
}

#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct BookingDraft {
    customer: CustomerDraft,
    items: Vec<LineItemDraft>,
    tags: Vec<String>,
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,
    note: Option<String>,
}
```

A failed nested read reports the path that a user would naturally inspect:

```
booking.items[2].customer.name expected GemStone value type String, got OOP 1234
```

This is the practical middle ground between raw OOPs and transparent object persistence: relationships are visible in config and generated Rust source, and the low-level OOP API remains available for special cases.

Comparison With MagLev/GBS

The MagLev branch example uses:

```
session bridgeRoot at: #MyTestDict put: payload.
session commitTransactionOrSignalConflict
```

The closest current `gemstone-rs` shape is:

```
let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;
bridge_root.put("MyTestDict", payload)?;
bridge_root.commit()?;
```

For typed Rust structs:

```
bridge_root.put_mapped("MyTestDict", &draft)?;
let loaded: BookingDraft = bridge_root.get_mapped("MyTestDict")?;
```

This is still explicit mapping, not transparent persistence. The benefit is that Rust teams can review every field mapping and still keep direct OOP access available when they need it.

Codegen Support

`gemstone-rs` codegen can emit `BridgeMapped` structs from config:

```
mapped = BookingDraft | doc=A typed Rust payload stored under BridgeRoot.
field = BookingDraft.name | type=String | key=name
field = BookingDraft.amount | type=SmallInt | key=amount | key_type=Symbol
field = BookingDraft.currency | type=String | key=currency
field = BookingDraft.tags | type=Vec<String> | key=tags
field = BookingDraft.labels | type=BTreeMap<String, String> | key=labels
field = BookingDraft.note | type=Option<String> | key=note
```

Generate a mapping config proposal from a live GemStone class:

```
gemstone-rs codegen discover-mapping gemstone-rs.codegen BookingDraft Object
```

For quick CLI inspection of the bridge root itself:

```
gemstone-rs bridge root
gemstone-rs bridge keys
gemstone-rs bridge get BookingDraft --symbol
gemstone-rs bridge value BookingDraft --depth 4
gemstone-rs bridge inspect BookingDraft --symbol
gemstone-rs bridge put-string WorkbenchDraft "hello from Rust"
gemstone-rs bridge put-symbol WorkbenchState ready
gemstone-rs bridge put-smallint WorkbenchCount 7
gemstone-rs bridge put-bool WorkbenchReady true
gemstone-rs bridge remove WorkbenchDraft
gemstone-rs bridge sample-config BookingDraft
```

Use `--root OtherBridgeRoot` when you intentionally use a non-default root dictionary, and `--key-type String|Symbol` when you want the key policy to be spelled out in scripts. Equals-style options such as `--root=OtherBridgeRoot`, `--key-type=Symbol`, and `--type=SmallInt` are accepted for CI scripts. The generic `bridge put --type String|Symbol|SmallInt|Bool` form is still available when the value type comes from script data.

`bridge keys` lists each root key with its key OOP, class OOP, `printString`, and session-local identity id.

Run the live discovery example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example codegen_discover_mapping
```

Run the generated mapping example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example generated_mapping_app
```

This is the recommended path for repeated mappings because the generated source is checked in and reviewed like any other Rust code.

Explorer and VS Code Support

The local explorer exposes BridgeRoot-oriented endpoints:

```
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/root
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/keys
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/get?key=BookingDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/put?key=WorkbenchDraft&value=hello'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/remove?key=WorkbenchDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/mapping-config?mapped=BookingDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/discover-mapping?
mapped=BookingDraft&class=Object'
```

The write endpoints require `gemstone-rs-explorer --allow-write`. Without that flag they return HTTP 403, matching the explorer's read-only default.

The VS Code workbench adds the same object-mapping workflow:

- GemStone RS: Generate Mapping Config
- GemStone RS: Preview BridgeRoot
- GemStone RS: List BridgeRoot Keys
- GemStone RS: Put BridgeRoot String
- GemStone RS: Put BridgeRoot Symbol
- GemStone RS: Put BridgeRoot SmallInt
- GemStone RS: Put BridgeRoot Bool

- `GemStone RS: Remove BridgeRoot Key`
- `GemStone RS: Run Generated Mapping Example`

The sidebar also shows these actions under `Codegen Config`.

Current Boundaries

The mapping layer is explicit, not transparent persistence. It does not yet make every GemStone object look like a native Rust object automatically. The current design is deliberately conservative:

- `Oop` remains visible and available.
- `Session` is still non-`Send` and non-`Sync`.
- writes happen only through explicit `put`, `put_mapped`, or generated code.
- the identity map is session-local and does not replace GemStone identity.

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